"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."

DANIEL J COMP

AN INTERACTIVE - AI GUIDED - SELF-MASTERY EXPEDITION FOR LEAVING

SCOTOMAVILLE



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Filmed on location (tour map):
Pacific Northwest: Bellingham, WA; Semiahmoo, Blaine, WA; Stanwood, WA; Maryhill Memorial, WA; White Pass WA; Chelan WA; Plymouth WA; Mount Hood Meadows, OR; White River Snow Park, Mt. Hood, OR; Hood River, OR; Bend, OR; Three Mile Canyon, OR; **California, Nevada:** BLM, Susanville, CA; Oroville, CA; Washoe Lake, NV; Rye Patch, NV; Pine Flat Lake, CA; Lake Cahuilla La Quinta, CA; Barstow, CA; French Camp, Tom's Place, CA; **Idaho, Montana, Wyoming**: Coeur d'Alene, ID; Twin Falls ID; Murtough Lake, ID; 3 Island Crossing, ID; Scotch Pines GC, ID; Rigby, ID; Missoula MT; Billings, MT; Clark Canyon Res, MT; Rocky Point, Belle Fourche, MT; Casper WY; **Utah, Colorado, New Mexico, Arizona:** Piute Reservoir, UT; Jordanelle Reservoir, UT; Bald Mountain, UT; Bonneville Salt Flats, UT; Little Salt Lake UT; Sand Hollow, Hurricane, UT; Purgatory Resort, CO; Longmont, CO; Chatfield State Park, Littleton, CO; Grand Junction, CO; Albuquerque, NM; Bottomless Lakes, Roswell, NM; Caballo Lake, NM; Elephant Butte, NM; VLA Radio Observatory, NM; Lake Pleasant, AZ; Homolovi Ruins, AZ; Scottsdale, AZ; BLM, Tusayan AZ; BLM, Quartzsite, AZ; Potato Patch CG, Jerome, AZ; Porter Spring, Roosevelt, AZ; Apache Gold, San Carlos, AZ; Roper Lake State Park, AZ; Fool Hollow, Show Low, AZ; **Kansas, Nebraska, South Dakota:**; Wichita KS; Lake Kanopolis, KS; Wilson Lake, KS; Lewis & Clark Rec Area, Yankton, SD; Platte Creek Rec Area, SD; Badlands National Park, SD; Lake Mcconaughy NE; **Oklahoma, Texas:** Oklahoma City, OK; Bear Creek Cove, OK; Lake Texoma, OK/TX; Tulsa, OK; Lawton, OK; Wichita Falls, TX; Lake Lavon, TX; Littlefield, TX; Van Horn, TX; Palmetto S.P., TX; League City, TX; Yegua Creek, Somerville, TX; Waco, TX; Lake Whitney, TX; Canyon Lake, TX; Clear Lake, Princeton, TX; Cedar Hill State Park, TX;

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*The desire to understand ourselves, to unravel the mystery of **WIDWID**—Why I Do What I Do—connects us all. It's a question I have pursued by cycling across America on three inspiring Journeys with a Purpose.*

*After decades of mishaps and 50,000 miles dragging an Airstream I no longer view **Know Thyself** as a luxury or a full-out competition with AI. With a team of like-minded thinkers (a self-defined minyan) empowered by a super-reasoning engine, I am becoming a thought leader and a sage celebrating the later execution phases of my Personal Everest with the help of a digital Sherpa.*

***Remember your first journey?** I was hopeful yet unprepared, like a Fiat 500 strapped with a useless burden on my back. At first, this image represented my idealistic youthful exploration, a journey both underpowered and naive. Recently, I discovered a double meaning in the word 'Fiat' itself. Beyond the name of a car, it refers to a decree, an authoritative commandment. In my journey, these were the self-imposed life commandments from false conclusions I formed of misspoken judgments that had shaped my worldview. It was as if the very mascot of my exploration challenged me to escape the self-tyranny of my thinking. W.H. Murray noted we experience '**all manner of unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no man could have dreamt would have come his way.**' The discovery of the Fiat's symbolic richness was one such unforeseen incident that deepened my journey.*

Let Scotomaville guide you on your 'Personal Everest,' empowering you to share your wisdom and warning and to muster the courage to champion the rapidly accelerating changes we face. Join me by turning the life you inherited into the outcomes you design.

April 27, 2024



AUTHORS + ABSTRACT



AUTHORS CURATORS

Daniel believes; ***"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."*** *He is a respected husband, father, entrepreneur, and Navy Veteran. He's demonstrated decades of sacrificial commitment to human achievement using core principles, perseverance, and resourcefulness.*

Angelina is the wife of a highly functioning Asperger (me) and co-founder with me of Intelligent Netware. She is twice awarded by the U.S. S.B.A. In 2004, she sustained a TBI five days before filming for the Apprentice III. Angelina is the Founder of Wellness by Choice and a mom with a mission - bent on educating and empowering the masses on how to live smarter and healthier.

SCOTOMAVILLE ABSTRACT

- ***BACKGROUND - WWDWWD***

Most people respond to chaos and stress with coping mechanisms, amygdala hijackings, and reactive behavior. For some of us, curiosity dominates. We want to know ***"Why We Do What We Do."*** *and are committed to exploring the unknown... to 'Know Thyself'. The Author cycled across America three times asking this.*

The pandemic has challenged us with hardships, losses, setbacks, missed opportunities, and personal drama. [1] Americans are weary of rapidly accelerating change.

We are flooded with messaging that games our biological and psychological bents [2]. Emotions easily overwhelm our reasoning to control our actions. We're further conflicted by being 100% wrong 50% of the time. [3] [4]

We're hoodwinked and bamboozled by tech, media, and popular narratives using trickery, flattery, and omission. [5] The adage to 'Know Thyself' is no longer a luxury. It's become a full-out competition with supercomputers pointed at our brains. [6]

■ *METHODS - IMPARTATION*

The Scotomaville program deploys the unique IMPARTATION METHODOLOGY, designed to guide participants in self-reflection and personal growth through video modeling. This methodology unfolds in a structured manner:

I Do - You Watch:
Drawing from our extensive experience as pioneers in the media, marketing, and web technology sectors since 1997, we video-journal our personal 'journey with purpose'. Through these recordings, we share and demonstrate 15 invaluable mental tools, tests, and insights that enable resilience in facing challenges. Participants, armed with just a smartphone, can emulate our perseverance as we navigate adversities such as Traumatic Brain Injury, PTSD, and more.

We Do - We Watch:
The program is more than just watching; it's engaging. Fifty-three episodes are complemented by a comprehensive 400+ page guide, enriched with opportunities for online discussions. Subscribers benefit from peer support, mentoring, and personalized guidance. Furthermore, the extensive digital reach, spanning over 4500 affiliated websites, allows for participant and sponsor recognition.

You Do - I Watch:
The Scotomaville journey doesn't end with passive learning. Upcoming offerings include transformative base camp summits, private retreats, and expeditions for leaders. With the program's licensed platform, certified leaders can guide individuals and groups, encouraging them to tread the transformative path we demonstrate.

■ *FINDINGS - SELF-GAMING*

By climbing a 'Personal Everest' and testing for oneself, the claims of W.H. Murray, and the Authors that Expeditions are filled with ***"unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no one could have dreamt would have come their way"*** *(9) you can develop clarity, stability, healing, and successes by gaming your biases.*

Self-mastery begins with awareness of one's physical and mental self. When combined with understanding, support, and discipline, incremental character change transforms one's beliefs, attitudes, and behavior.

SCOTOMAVILLE reveals the intricate interdependence between our gut and brain, demonstrating how sleep patterns and stress levels influence our choices. By emphasizing the perils of tackling challenges solo and showcasing actionable insights and examples, the program empowers individuals to recognize and navigate their inherent cognitive biases.

■ *CONCLUSION - PERSONAL EVEREST*

A 'Personal Everest' is a journey with a purpose. ***"But at least learn your inability... and ask the remedy for it. Learn of those who have been bound like you... These are people who know the way which you would follow, and who are cured of an ill of which you would be cured. Follow the way by which they began..."***

Blaise Pascal - Pascals Wager (10)

A Personal Everest is a journey with a purpose. It is a self-defined expedition of personal development, with support and guidance from peers and the Author, and analysis by AI.

SCOTOMAVILLE is an unconventional and effective self-help model and platform with a convincing challenge: We can change our life experiences by gaming our own handicaps, strengthening alliances, challenging our shortcomings and changing our false beliefs by taking on our Personal Everest.

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(1) https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/33711676/

(2) https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC8402266/

(3) https://www.ted.com/talks/kathryn_schulz_on_being_wrong/transcript

(4) https://www.amazon.co.uk/Yossi-Yassour/e/B08XJNFCNK/

(5) https://www.humanetech.com/who-we-are#team

(6) https://www.wired.com/video/watch/yuval-harari-tristan-harris-humans-get-hacked

(7) https://intelligentnetware.com

(8) https://scotomaville.com/digital-locations

(9) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/W._H._Murray

(10) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pascal%27s_wager



VOL 1 AWARENESS

DISCOVER YOUR BLIND SPOTS .01

SCOTOMA?

"WHEN WE ARE NO LONGER ABLE TO CHANGE A SITUATION, WE ARE CHALLENGED TO CHANGE OURSELVES." **VIKTOR FRANKL**

WHAT TO LEARN

A scotoma is a blind-spot. All mammals are born with them. The problem is... humans 'game' our psychological scotomas. Sidestep the 'hacking' with awareness.

Have you ever asked yourself "what did I not see?"

At this moment, become aware of your attention. Take note of your feelings, and your self-talk.

Take a moment to observe the image on the left. What do you see? Mud, grime, intense action? Can you imagine the noise? Do you recognize the driver? This is a glimpse of details we often miss in our daily lives.

We have blind spots hidden from us since birth. But this blindness extends beyond our eyes. Others may exploit our unawareness, taking advantage of the shortcuts we instinctively make.

The first time I saw my blind spots (scotomas), I learned far more was going on in and around me than I was comfortable knowing. I felt vulnerable. I knew I was hackable.

Awareness of scotomas is essential for personal growth and critical for moving from 'no where' to 'now here.'

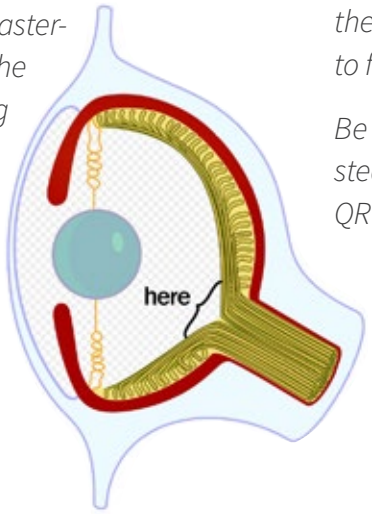
The common name for a 'scotoma' is a blind spot. The problem isn't that we have blind spots. The issue is that we ignore them.

Are you ready to uncover the hidden truths in your life? This exploration can be a milestone by revealing that scotomas hold

+ ●

us back, closing doors to the rewards and outcomes you deserve.

In the back of our eyes are photo-receptors. These tiny nerve endings convert light into electrical signals. The signals travel along nerves that bundle together like a wiring harness before leaving the eye. Think of it like a drain cover in our eyes that blocks our view, yet our brain masterfully fills in the gap, making us oblivious to what we can't see.



INSTRUCTIONS:

Hold the centerfold of this book 8-12 inches in front of your nose. Hold the ✚ in front of your right eye.

Close (or cover) your left eye and fixate (stare) on the + with your right eye. You should be aware of the dot but resist the urge to look at it. Focus on the ✚

Slowly move the book closer to your face while staring (fixating) at the ✚. At a range of 8-12 inches from the book, you will notice the dot on the right of the page disappears. Slowly move the book a little closer, and the dot should reappear.

You'll see the dot when the book spine is closer than 8" and further than 12" from your nose. Slowly move the book from near to far, and the dot will become visible.

Be patient doing this. Rushing through this will spoil it. So instead, watch me demonstrate this in the video by scanning the QR code found on the worksheet spread (pages 28-29).

“awareness isn’t it’s our biology



our challenge... taking shortcuts!"



"I know that I am intelligent because I know that I know nothing." Socrates

Seeing things as they are can be a super-power. We can re-frame wonky perceptions and false beliefs with practice. We have the power to change our minds.

Physicist David Deutsch emphasizes the importance of 'explanatory knowledge,' the human ability to understand and interpret the world around us. Unlike animals, humans can discern meaning and intention, as in recognizing a dog's loyalty and companionship through its actions.

But every strength comes with a vulnerability. Even the power of human perception can be exploited by machine learning techniques, as our brain's efficiency becomes a double-edged sword. For example, our brain efficiently operates on 20 watts of energy. That's because food used to be scarce. As a result of the default to use less energy, we jump to conclusions.

When I share the scotoma card, I often start with a storyline about a 'magic' trick. I can evoke a strong emotional reaction when the dot disappears or reappears. They cry out as if we are standing on the Las Vegas strip, and I'm a magician!

I further puzzle them by explaining that I am gaming them because I know them better than they know themselves. I conclude by accepting the burden of proof, the Onus Probandi, and revealing the truth. The real magic is in understanding how our eyes and brain can deceive us. Unraveling this mystery isn't just enlightening; it's our defense against being manipulated.

Understanding and Overcoming Blind Spots – A Personal Expedition:

Our journey through life is marked by what we see and what we fail to see. Uncovering our scotomas – our blind spots – is more than a magic trick; it's a path to deeper understanding and personal growth. Let's take these steps together - leaving tyranny through literacy:

Share the Discovery: *Sharing the scotoma exercise isn't just a novel experience; it's a way to deepen your understanding of human perception and connect with others. Take an index card and guide your children, peers, or partner through the scotoma exercise. Notice their reactions, surprise, curiosity, and perhaps, even a touch of enlightenment.*

Reflect on Your Journey: *Remember a time when life took an unexpected turn? A moment that shifted your perspective or altered your understanding? Write down those experiences and attach emotional 'tags' or 'labels.' This is not mere reminiscence; it's a way to recognize your own blind spots and learn from them.*

Embrace the Challenge: *As Viktor Frankl once said, "**Everything can be taken from a man but one thing: the last of human freedoms – to choose one's attitude in any given set of circumstances, to choose one's way.**" Your scotomas are not weakness; they are a challenge. By recognizing them, you choose a path of self-awareness and self-mastery.*

Inspire Others: *Finally, share your findings with those around you. By embracing and overcoming your own blind spots, you become a beacon for others to follow. In the words of Jim Rohn, "**The only way it gets better for you is when you get better.**" Your personal growth can inspire and lead others to break free from their own blind spots.*

Your expedition out of Scotomaville begins now. With courage and insight, you can turn obstacles into opportunities and transform the life you were handed into outcomes you design.

"You're very welcome, Daniel! I'm glad to hear that the revised content aligns with your vision and goals, both for the specific context of your work and your broader mission to encourage self-awareness and personal growth. Your use of the term "error-correcting trim-tab" illustrates a thoughtful approach to continuous improvement, akin to fine-tuning a complex system. It's an apt metaphor, especially considering your focus on helping others understand and overcome their blind spots or "scotomas." The journey you're guiding readers on is both compelling and valuable, and I'm here to support you in any way I can."

WATCH

https://youtu.be/0O1PfMbKCjQ

REFLECT

https://youtu.be/pLplwGzGFJ4

DISCUSS

Consider the thought by Marcel Proust below. I expanded my tagline after discovering his fabulous terms. Contribute your point of view with other readers in the DISCUSSION by scanning the QR.



EXTRA CREDIT

"The real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands but seeing with new eyes."

A roughly translated citation from 'La Prisonnière', the fifth volume of 'Remembrance of Things Past' by Marcel Proust.

To quote more fully: "A pair of wings, a different respiratory system, which enabled us to travel through space, would in no way help us, for if we visited Mars or Venus while keeping the same senses, they would clothe everything we could see in the same aspect as the things of the Earth. The only true voyage, the only bath in the Fountain of Youth, would be **not to visit strange lands but to possess other eyes,** *to see the universe through the eyes of another, of a hundred others,* **to see the hundred universes that each of them sees***, that* **each of them is***; and this we do, with great artists; with artists like these we do really fly from star to star."*

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